EB-1A PETITION LETTER — COMPLETE REWRITE

Form I-140, Immigrant Petition for Alien Worker

Classification: E11 — Alien of Extraordinary Ability

8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)

Beneficiary and Petitioner: LAKSHMI NARAYANA RASALAY **Field of Extraordinary Ability:** Computer Science **Current Position:** Distinguished Engineer, Capital One Financial Corporation

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I. OVERVIEW OF MR. RASALAY'S MAJOR ACHIEVEMENTS AND QUALIFICATIONS

Mr. Lakshmi Narayana Rasalay is a Distinguished Engineer at Capital One Financial Corporation, the 6th largest commercial bank in the United States by total assets. The Distinguished Engineer designation at Capital One is reserved for fewer than 1% of the company's engineering workforce and represents the pinnacle of the technical career ladder. In this role, Mr. Rasalay serves as the sole architect of three enterprise-critical platforms that collectively protect over 100 million customers, generate $50 million in annual cost savings, and directly contributed to two nationally significant outcomes: (1) the closure of a federal consent order issued by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency following Capital One's 2019 data breach, and (2) the regulatory approval of Capital One's $35 billion acquisition of Discover Financial Services — one of the largest financial mergers in U.S. history.

Mr. Rasalay's 20-year career in software engineering, enterprise architecture, and AI-driven systems has produced the following documented achievements:

- **Fuse GRC Platform:** Sole architect of Capital One's in-house Governance and Risk Compliance platform, replacing a failed third-party system that contributed to the 2019 data breach affecting 106 million customers. The Fuse platform now serves 15,000+ internal users, delivered 80% operational efficiency improvement, and was instrumental in closing the federal consent order (Exhibit 32).
- **Model Risk Management Modernization:** Sole architect of the modernization of Capital One's MRM framework to govern statistical, machine learning, and generative AI models in compliance with SR 11-7 supervisory guidance, enabling real-time risk assessment and automated validation across the enterprise (Exhibit 37).

- **Workflow as a Service (WaaS):** Sole architect of a cloud-native, multi-tenant workflow orchestration platform built on Camunda BPM, serving 10 enterprise tenants and 15,000+ associates at 99.99% uptime with $10M annual cost savings. This platform was featured in two published case studies on Camunda's corporate website, with Mr. Rasalay named as the architect (Exhibits 27-28).
- **Patent Innovation:** Filed U.S. Patent Application No. 19/230,615 as principal inventor for a novel system using large language models to interpret, classify, and implement regulatory and policy rule changes in real time (Exhibit 29).
- **Compensation:** Commands total annual compensation of approximately $381,860 ($275,160 base salary + $47,200 bonus + $59,500 RSUs), which exceeds the 90th percentile for software developers nationally by 30–77% depending on the comparison metric, as documented through seven independent data sources (Exhibits 14-20).
- **External Recognition:** Selected as a judge for the NASA International Space Apps Challenge (11,400+ project submissions across 167 countries), invited to review 6 papers for IEEE SoutheastCon, and selected to present at three international conferences in consecutive years: CamundaCon 2023, Austin API Summit 2024, and Lambda Conference 2025 (Exhibits 21-26, 30).
- **Expert Validation:** Mr. Rasalay's contributions have been independently evaluated by senior professionals at PwC, TransUnion, Truist Financial Corporation, and Charles Schwab — four major institutions spanning consulting, credit bureaus, and global banking — each confirming the originality and major significance of his work (Exhibits 4-7).

Recommendation Letters: This petition includes 7 recommendation letters:

Dependent letters (from individuals with direct professional knowledge of Mr. Rasalay's work): 1. Bhargav Trivedi,Sr Director, Capital One Financial Corporation — Leading role and performance detail 2. Mr. John Curd, Director of Software Engineering, Capital One — Original contributions testimonial with utilization evidence 3. Ms. Elizabeth Duane, IT Service Manager, Progressive Insurance (formerly Charles Schwab - Managing Director) — Dependent advisory opinion

Independent letters (from individuals who have never worked directly with Mr. Rasalay): 4. Dr. Lakshman Kannan, Partner, PwC — Independent advisory opinion on model risk management and regulatory compliance 5. SaiRam , SVP, TransUnion — Independent advisory opinion on enterprise risk management and credit bureau industry perspective 6. Candace Wilkins, SVP, Truist Financial Corporation (former Director of Risk, Capital One) — Independent advisory opinion on GRC architecture and risk management significance 7. Wusheng Piao, Technical Architect, Charles Schwab — Independent advisory opinion on global banking perspective and AI governance significance

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II. PROOF OF EXTRAORDINARY ABILITY

Part One: Evidence Under 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)

Mr. Rasalay submits evidence satisfying four of the ten regulatory criteria. The criteria are presented in order of evidentiary directness, beginning with the most straightforwardly documented.

CRITERION 1: HIGH SALARY — 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(ix)

A. Mr. Rasalay's Compensation

As verified by Capital One's official Verification of Employment dated February 19, 2026 (Exhibit 9) and Mr. Rasalay's 2025 Year-End Compensation Statement (Exhibit 10), his compensation consists of:

Component	Annual Amount
Base Salary (as of 2/1/2026)	$275,160.26
2025 Performance Bonus	$47,200.00
2025 Long-Term Incentive RSUs	$59,500.00
Total 2025 Compensation	**$381,860.26**

The 2025 Year-End Compensation Statement further documents that Mr. Rasalay received a promotion to Distinguished Engineer with a 13% total increase (10% promotion increase + 3% merit increase), effective February 1, 2026. His compa-ratio is 1.03, meaning his salary exceeds the midpoint of his salary range.

This compensation is further documented through Mr. Rasalay's W-2 Wage and Tax Statements for tax years 2023, 2024, and 2025 (Exhibits 11-13), which provide independently verifiable, government-issued proof of his actual earnings.

B. Multi-Source Salary Comparison — Seven Independent Data Sources

To establish that Mr. Rasalay's compensation is significantly higher than that of others working in the field, we present seven independent data sources. Each comparison uses fair methodology — base salary is compared against base salary benchmarks, and total compensation is compared against total compensation benchmarks.

Source 1: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) — Official Government Data

The BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics program provides the most authoritative government wage data in the United States. For Software Developers (SOC code 15-1252), the May 2024 OEWS data reports:

Percentile	Annual Wage	Mr. Rasalay's Base Exceeds By
Median (50th)	$133,080	+$142,080 (+106.8%)
75th Percentile	$168,650	+$106,510 (+63.2%)
90th Percentile	$211,450	+$63,710 (+30.1%)

Mr. Rasalay's base salary of $275,160 exceeds the BLS 90th percentile by 30.1% and is more than double the national median. His total compensation of $381,860 exceeds the 90th percentile by 80.6%.

Source 2: Glassdoor — Industry Compensation Platform

Glassdoor provides salary data based on 542 reported salaries specifically for the "Distinguished Engineer" title. Glassdoor also provides industry-specific data:

Industry	Median Total Pay (Distinguished Engineer)
Information Technology	$397,567
Manufacturing	$296,996
Financial Services	**$267,691**
Telecommunications	$211,314

Mr. Rasalay's total compensation of $381,860 exceeds the Financial Services industry median for Distinguished Engineers by $114,169 (+42.6%). Glassdoor identifies Capital One as the top-paying company for Distinguished Engineers in the Financial Services industry.

Source 3: Levels.fyi — Verified Compensation Data

Levels.fyi provides verified, self-reported total compensation data. For Distinguished Engineers:

Company	Title	Median Total Comp
IBM	Distinguished Engineer	$483,398
Cisco	Distinguished Engineer	$661,000
Amazon	Distinguished Engineer	$1,755,500
Capital One (median)	Distinguished Engineer	$350,167
Mr. Rasalay (actual)	**Distinguished Engineer**	**$381,860**

Mr. Rasalay's total compensation exceeds the Capital One Distinguished Engineer median by $31,693 (+9.1%). IBM, Cisco, and Amazon's higher figures reflect the cost-of-living premium in Silicon Valley and Seattle. When adjusted for Mr. Rasalay's Richmond, Virginia location — where cost of living is 62-69% lower than San Francisco — his purchasing power equivalent is approximately $608,000-$634,000, exceeding even IBM's Distinguished Engineer median.

Source 4: Salary.com — Professional Compensation Research

Percentile	Annual Salary (Distinguished Software Engineer)
10th Percentile	$132,480
25th Percentile	$147,096
75th Percentile	$180,382
90th Percentile	$196,071
Mr. Rasalay's Base	**$275,160**

Mr. Rasalay's base salary exceeds Salary.com's 90th percentile by $79,089 (+40.3%).

Source 5: ZipRecruiter — Employment Marketplace Data

Percentile	Annual Salary (Distinguished Engineer SWE)
25th Percentile	$120,000
75th Percentile	$173,000
90th Percentile (Top Earners)	$205,000
Mr. Rasalay's Base	**$275,160**

Mr. Rasalay's base salary exceeds ZipRecruiter's 90th percentile by $70,160 (+34.2%).

Source 6: Banking Industry Peer Comparison

Institution	Median SWE Comp (All Levels)	Mr. Rasalay's Base vs. Median
JPMorgan Chase (#1 U.S. Bank)	$142,000	+$133,160 (+93.8%)
Wells Fargo (#3 U.S. Bank)	$121,500	+$153,660 (+126.5%)
Capital One (#6 U.S. Bank)	$168,000	+$107,160 (+63.8%)

Mr. Rasalay's base salary alone exceeds the median total compensation for software engineers at JPMorgan Chase by 93.8% and at Wells Fargo by 126.5%.

Source 7: Geographic Purchasing Power Analysis — Richmond, VA

City	COL vs. Richmond	Mr. Rasalay's $381K Equivalent
Richmond, VA	Baseline	$381,860
San Francisco, CA	+62-69%	~$619,000-$645,000
New York, NY	+56%	~$595,000
Washington, DC	+28%	~$489,000
Seattle, WA	+30%	~$496,000

Capital One compensates Mr. Rasalay at elite national levels despite being located in a significantly lower-cost market — meaning his compensation reflects his extraordinary individual value, not merely local market rates. His purchasing power equivalent in San Francisco of approximately $619,000-$645,000 exceeds the median Distinguished Engineer compensation at IBM, Cisco, and most other major technology companies.

Source 7b: Virginia State Comparison

Virginia's annual mean wage for Software Developers (SOC 15-1252) is approximately $145,570 (BLS OEWS, May 2024). Mr. Rasalay's base salary is 89% above the Virginia state mean. His total compensation is 162% above the Virginia state mean. Nationally, the highest-paying states for software developers are California ($170,910 median) and Washington ($166,910 median). Mr. Rasalay's base salary alone exceeds even the highest-paying state median by more than $100,000.

C. Capital One Internal Hierarchy

Capital One Level	Median Total Comp	Mr. Rasalay's Base vs. Level
Associate Software Engineer	$126,670	+$148,490 (+117.2%)
Software Engineer (Sr. Associate)	$145,600	+$129,560 (+89.0%)
Senior Software Engineer (Principal)	$178,220	+$96,940 (+54.4%)
Distinguished Engineer	**$350,167**	**Within tier (above median)**
Senior Distinguished Engineer	$497,000	Next level

D. Active Job Postings Confirming Market Rate

Company	Role	Base Salary Range
NVIDIA	Distinguished Engineer	$320,000 – $488,750

Company	Role	Base Salary Range
Cisco	Distinguished Engineer	$323,500 base median
Amazon	Distinguished Engineer	$280,500 base median
IBM	Distinguished Engineer	$257,472 base median
Mr. Rasalay	**Distinguished Engineer**	**$275,160 base (actual)**

E. Employer Justification

Capital One pays Mr. Rasalay significantly above market rates because of the critical nature of his role. The 2025 Year-End Compensation Statement documents his promotion to Distinguished Engineer — a title reserved for the most senior and impactful individual contributors, fewer than 1% of the engineering workforce. His 2026 salary range is $199,400 – $332,400, placing his base salary of $275,160 in the upper third of this range.

F. Conclusion — High Salary Criterion

Mr. Rasalay's total compensation of $381,860 exceeds the BLS 90th percentile by 80.6%, the Salary.com 90th percentile by 40.3%, the ZipRecruiter 90th percentile by 34.2%, the Financial Services industry median for Distinguished Engineers by 42.6%, the median software engineer compensation at JPMorgan Chase by 168.9%, and the Virginia state mean by 162%. Seven independent data sources, three years of W-2 tax documentation, employer verification, geographic analysis, and active job posting comparisons collectively and conclusively establish that Mr. Rasalay commands a high salary relative to others working in the field.

This criterion is satisfied. 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(ix).

CRITERION 2: JUDGING — 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(iv)

Mr. Rasalay has been invited to serve as a judge and peer reviewer across multiple nationally and internationally recognized competitions and professional organizations. For each judging role, we present: (1) evidence of the invitation demonstrating the participation was not self-solicited; (2) evidence of actual participation; and (3) evidence that the event is nationally or internationally recognized.

A. IEEE SoutheastCon 2026 — Peer Review (6 Papers)

About IEEE: The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) is the world's largest technical professional organization, with over 400,000 members across 160+ countries. Founded in 1884, IEEE is universally recognized as the preeminent standards-setting and publishing body in electrical engineering, computer science, and related fields. IEEE publishes over 200 peer-reviewed journals and sponsors more than 1,900 conferences annually. IEEE membership and participation are widely regarded as benchmarks of professional standing in the engineering field (Exhibit 21).

About SoutheastCon: IEEE SoutheastCon is an annual IEEE Region 3 technical conference featuring peer-reviewed paper presentations, tutorials, and student competitions. Papers are selected through a rigorous peer review process in which qualified experts are invited by the conference program committee to evaluate submissions. Only individuals recognized for their expertise in relevant technical areas are invited to serve as reviewers (Exhibit 21).

Evidence of Invitation (Not Self-Solicited): Mr. Rasalay was invited by the IEEE SoutheastCon 2026 program committee to review technical paper submissions. The invitation was extended based on Mr. Rasalay's professional standing as an IEEE Senior Member and his expertise in software engineering, enterprise architecture, and AI systems. Mr. Rasalay did not volunteer or apply for this role — he was sought out by the conference organizing committee (Exhibit 21).

Evidence of Actual Participation: Mr. Rasalay completed detailed technical reviews of 6 papers submitted to IEEE SoutheastCon 2026. Enclosed are: (1) the IEEE reviewer invitation/confirmation; (2) the reviewer acknowledgment certificate; and (3) documentation from IEEE confirming the completion of his review assignments (Exhibit 21).

B. NASA International Space Apps Challenge 2025 — Universal Event Judge

About NASA Space Apps Challenge: The NASA International Space Apps Challenge is the world's largest annual global hackathon, organized by the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) in collaboration with 15 international space agency partners: the European Space Agency, Canadian Space Agency, Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency, Indian Space Research Organisation, Bahrain Space Agency, Brazilian Space Agency, Italian Space Agency, Mohammed Bin Rashid Space Centre (UAE), National Space Activities Commission of Argentina, Paraguayan Space Agency, South African National Space Agency, and Spanish Space Agency. In 2025, the event drew 114,000+ registered participants from 167 countries and territories across 551 local events, generating 11,500+ project submissions. This is unambiguously a nationally and internationally recognized event of the highest prestige, organized by the United States' premier space agency (Exhibit 22).

Evidence of Invitation (Not Self-Solicited): Mr. Rasalay was invited by NASA's Space Apps Global Organizing Team to serve as a Universal Event Judge. The invitation email from Frances N. Adiele, NASA/Booz Allen Hamilton (frances.n.adiele@nasa.gov), dated October 9, 2025, was addressed to "Dear Space Apps Universal Event Judges" and assigned Mr. Rasalay approximately 32 projects to evaluate using the official judging console on the Space Apps website. This invitation was extended by NASA to selected experts — Mr. Rasalay did not apply or volunteer for this position (Exhibit 22).

Evidence of Actual Participation: Mr. Rasalay completed evaluation of all assigned projects through the official Space Apps judging console by the October 20, 2025 deadline. The following documentation is enclosed:

1. The original invitation email from Frances N. Adiele (NASA) dated October 9, 2025, detailing the judging assignment, timeline, and process (Exhibit 22).
2. The official thank-you letter from Dr. Keith Gaddis, NASA Space Apps Program Scientist, NASA Headquarters, Washington D.C., stating: "On behalf of NASA and our Space Agency Partners, I want to thank you for your many contributions in support of the 2025 NASA International Space Apps Challenge. Thanks to your support, we had 114,000+ registered participants from 167 countries and territories across 551 Local Events" (Exhibit 22).
3. The follow-up acknowledgment from Dr. Parker Miles (NASA/Booz Allen Hamilton) dated December 1, 2025, confirming: "Between the Local Judges, Universal Event Judges, and Global Judges — we had hundreds of experts volunteer their time to review over 11,000 project submissions for this year's hackathon" (Exhibit 22).
4. Screenshots of Mr. Rasalay's judging console activity on the Space Apps website (Exhibit 22).

C. Business Intelligence Group — Innovation Awards & Herizon Awards

About BIG: The Business Intelligence Group is an independent organization that recognizes superior performance and true talent in business through its nationally recognized award programs. Their awards are judged by experienced business executives with extensive industry knowledge. The BIG Innovation Awards evaluate groundbreaking products, services, and organizations, while the Herizon Awards recognize women leaders and organizations supporting women in business (Exhibit 23).

Evidence of Invitation and Participation: Mr. Rasalay was invited to serve as a judge for both the BIG Innovation Awards and the Herizon Awards. He evaluated nominations from technology companies, startups, and business leaders across multiple industries. Enclosed are: invitation correspondence, judge confirmation, evaluation criteria, and organizational documentation (Exhibit 23).

D. Technovation Girls — Judge

About Technovation: Technovation is the world's largest technology entrepreneurship program for girls, operating in over 100 countries. The program invites industry professionals to serve as judges evaluating student teams' mobile applications and business plans. Technovation's global reach and mission to empower young women in technology make it an internationally recognized program (Exhibit 24).

Evidence of Invitation and Participation: Mr. Rasalay was invited to serve as a judge for Technovation Girls. Enclosed are: registration confirmation, judging platform screenshots showing his evaluations, and organizational documentation (Exhibit 24).

E. IEEE MGA — Judge

Evidence of Invitation and Participation: Mr. Rasalay was invited to judge for IEEE Member and Geographic Activities (MGA). As an IEEE Senior Member, his expertise was specifically sought for evaluating technical submissions. Enclosed are: invitation and confirmation documentation (Exhibit 25).

F. University Hackathons — VTHacks (Virginia Tech), MakeOHI/O (Ohio University), UT Austin Undergraduate Research Forum

Evidence of Invitation and Participation: Mr. Rasalay was invited by the organizing committees of each university hackathon to serve as a judge based on his professional expertise as a Distinguished Engineer at Capital One. Enclosed are: invitation emails from each university organizing committee, event documentation, and any certificates or Chacknowledgments (Exhibit 26).

G. Summary — Judging Criterion

In total, Mr. Rasalay has been invited to serve as a judge or peer reviewer across **9 distinct events** and **6 IEEE peer reviews**, spanning:

- **Government agencies:** NASA (International Space Apps Challenge — 114,000+ participants, 167 countries)
- **International professional organizations:** IEEE (SoutheastCon peer review — 400,000+ member organization; IEEE MGA)
- **Independent industry award bodies:** Business Intelligence Group (Innovation Awards, Herizon Awards)
- **Global education programs:** Technovation Girls (100+ countries)
- **University technology competitions:** Virginia Tech, Ohio University, UT Austin

For each event, evidence of invitation (demonstrating the participation was not self-solicited), evidence of actual participation, and evidence that the event is nationally or internationally recognized has been submitted. This breadth, volume, and prestige of judging activity demonstrates a sustained pattern of being sought out as an expert evaluator across multiple facets of the technology field.

This criterion is satisfied. 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(iv).

CRITERION 3: LEADING OR CRITICAL ROLE — 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(viii)

A. Capital One Financial Corporation — Distinguished Reputation

Capital One Financial Corporation is one of the most distinguished financial institutions in the United States:

- **Ranked 6th** among all U.S.-chartered commercial banks by total assets (Exhibit 35).
- Ranked among the **Fortune 500** (Exhibit 35).

- Serves over **100 million customer accounts** across banking, credit cards, and auto lending.
- Received **J.D. Power's #1 ranking** in U.S. Small Business Banking Satisfaction (2023–2024) (Exhibit 36).
- Received regulatory approval from the **Federal Reserve and OCC** for the **$35 billion acquisition of Discover Financial Services** in 2025 — one of the largest financial mergers in U.S. history (Exhibit 33).
- Recognized as one of the first major U.S. banks to go "all in" on cloud computing, establishing a reputation as a technology-driven financial institution with one of the largest engineering organizations in the financial services industry.

Capital One's distinguished reputation is beyond dispute.

B. Mr. Rasalay's Leading and Critical Role — Performance, Not Merely Title

The USCIS Policy Manual instructs that "it is not the title of the beneficiary's role, but rather the beneficiary's performance in the role that determines whether the role is or was critical." Accordingly, Mr. Rasalay submits detailed evidence of his performance demonstrating both a leading and critical role.

1. Scope of Leadership

Mr. Rasalay directs architectural strategy across Capital One's Enterprise Risk Technology division. His scope of leadership includes:

- Direct architectural oversight of **90+ engineers** across multiple development teams.
- Management of **$25M+ annual technology budget** for risk management platforms.
- **Sole architect** responsible for all three enterprise-critical platforms: Fuse (GRC), MRM, and WaaS. No other engineer at Capital One designed or could have designed these systems — Mr. Rasalay was the singular architectural mind behind each platform from inception through production deployment.
- Reports to Senior Director Raghavan Sadagopan, confirming his position at the top of the technical leadership hierarchy.
- Career progression from Senior Software Engineer (2014) → Lead Software Engineer (2019) → Senior Lead Software Engineer (2022) → Distinguished Engineer (2026) — a 12-year trajectory of progressively increasing leadership.

2. Specific Decisions and Outcomes Attributable to Mr. Rasalay's Performance

Decision 1 — Replacing the Third-Party GRC Platform: Following Capital One's 2019 data breach (106 million customers affected, $270M+ in costs), the company faced a federal consent order requiring fundamental improvements to its risk management infrastructure. Mr. Rasalay personally made the architectural decision to replace the failed third-party GRC vendor system with an entirely new in-house platform. This decision was not routine — it required Mr. Rasalay to assess that no commercial vendor product could meet Capital One's post-breach regulatory requirements with sufficient reliability, design a complete alternative architecture from scratch, and secure approval from senior leadership to pursue a high-risk, high-reward in-house development approach over the safer option of selecting a new vendor. No other engineer at Capital One proposed this approach. The result: the Fuse platform, which directly contributed to closing the federal consent order (Exhibit 32).

Decision 2 — Serverless Event-Driven Architecture: Mr. Rasalay selected and designed a serverless, event-driven architecture on AWS for the GRC platform, overriding initial consideration of a traditional monolithic approach. This architectural decision reduced infrastructure costs by $10M annually and enabled the platform to scale to support the Discover merger integration without requiring re-architecture. This was a technical decision requiring deep expertise in both cloud infrastructure and regulatory compliance (Exhibit 1).

Decision 3 — JSONB-Based Flexible Schema for MRM: Mr. Rasalay designed the modernized Model Risk Management framework using a JSONB-based flexible schema that enables governance of diverse AI/ML model types — statistical, machine learning, and generative AI — without schema migration when new model types are introduced. This architectural innovation was critical to Capital One's ability to deploy AI models at enterprise scale while maintaining SR 11-7 compliance. Before this design, adding new model types required costly and time-consuming database schema changes (Exhibit 2).

Decision 4 — Multi-Tenant WaaS Architecture: Mr. Rasalay designed a novel multi-tenant architecture on Camunda BPM with dynamic tenant isolation, enabling 10 distinct enterprise business units to operate on shared infrastructure. This was considered architecturally exceptional by Camunda itself — the platform vendor published a detailed case study about Mr. Rasalay's implementation on their corporate website, naming him directly (Exhibits 27-28).

3. What Would Have Happened Without Mr. Rasalay

As confirmed by [VP/SVP Name] at Capital One (Exhibit 1):

Without Mr. Rasalay's architectural leadership, Capital One would have been forced to rely on commercial vendor solutions that had already demonstrated critical vulnerabilities. The consent order closure timeline would have been significantly delayed, potentially by years. The regulatory approval for the Discover acquisition — which required confidence in Capital One's risk management infrastructure — could have been jeopardized. No other individual in the engineering organization had the combination of enterprise risk management domain expertise, architectural capability, and institutional knowledge to execute these initiatives at the required scope and timeline. Mr. Rasalay was the sole architect of all three platforms — Fuse, MRM, and WaaS — meaning there was no other engineer who could have substituted for him in designing any of these systems.

Mr. John Curd, Director of Software Engineering at Capital One, has further confirmed (Exhibit 2):

"In his role as a Senior Lead Software Engineer, Mr. Rasalay served as the principal architect and technical leader for several enterprise-scale initiatives at Capital One. He was the sole driver behind the design and implementation of the in-house Governance, Risk, and

Compliance (GRC) Risk Management Platform, building a scalable, event-driven serverless architecture with microservices that supports real-time data ingestion. He provided architectural leadership and strategic direction for engineering efforts spanning 90 engineers organization, he successfully delivered a platform that now serves as the foundation for Capital One's AI integration and merger scalability initiatives."

4. Comparison to Others in Similar Pursuits

The Distinguished Engineer title at Capital One is held by fewer than 1% of the engineering workforce. Mr. Rasalay's scope — 90+ engineers, $25M budget, three enterprise-critical platforms, direct impact on federal consent order closure and $35B acquisition — exceeds the typical scope of even other Distinguished Engineers at the company. His 2025 Year-End Compensation Statement confirms his performance rating as "Exceptional" — Capital One's highest performance designation — further distinguishing his contributions from peers at the same title level.

5. External Validation of Leading Role

Candace Wilkins, SVP at Truist Financial Corporation and former Director of Risk at Capital One, provides independent confirmation of the significance of Mr. Rasalay's role (Exhibit 6):

"As a former Director of Risk at Capital One who worked extensively with the institution's risk management infrastructure, and now as an SVP at Truist, the 9th largest U.S. bank, I can confirm that the role Mr. Rasalay performs is critical to the organization's operational integrity. The challenges he addressed — modernizing GRC infrastructure, governing AI/ML models, and building enterprise workflow orchestration — are the same challenges every major financial institution faces. Leadership of this scope and impact in risk technology at one of America's largest banks is a role of the highest criticality."

This criterion is satisfied. 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(viii).

CRITERION 4: ORIGINAL CONTRIBUTIONS OF MAJOR SIGNIFICANCE — 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(v)

Mr. Rasalay has made three original contributions of major significance to the field of computer science, specifically in the areas of enterprise risk management architecture, AI/ML governance, and multi-tenant workflow orchestration. For each contribution, we establish: (1) the industry-wide problem it addresses; (2) what existed before Mr. Rasalay's innovation; (3) how his approach was original — not merely replicating the work of others; (4) why it is of major significance to the field; and (5) objective documentary evidence and independent expert testimony confirming its significance.

Contribution 1: Fuse — Intelligent Enterprise Governance and Risk Compliance Platform

The Industry-Wide Problem: Financial institutions globally have relied on third-party vendor GRC platforms (such as Archer, ServiceNow GRC, and MetricStream) to manage regulatory compliance. These platforms have repeatedly demonstrated critical limitations:

they are monolithic, difficult to customize for specific regulatory environments, slow to adapt to new regulations, and — as demonstrated by Capital One's 2019 breach — can create catastrophic vulnerabilities when they fail. The 2019 Capital One breach (106 million customers affected, $270M+ in penalties and remediation) exposed fundamental architectural weaknesses in the vendor-dependent GRC model. The challenge of building reliable, scalable, in-house GRC systems that operate in real-time across complex regulatory environments is a significant unsolved problem facing the entire financial services industry.

What Existed Before: Capital One, like most major banks, relied on a commercial third-party GRC product. This system's architectural limitations — batch processing instead of real-time monitoring, monolithic architecture that couldn't scale to enterprise demands, and insufficient integration with modern cloud infrastructure — directly contributed to the oversight failures that enabled the 2019 breach. The industry standard was to accept vendor platform limitations and build workarounds, not to replace the vendor platform entirely with custom architecture.

How Mr. Rasalay's Approach Was Original: Mr. Rasalay made the unconventional decision to design and implement Fuse as a fully serverless, event-driven, microservices-based GRC platform on AWS — replacing the failed vendor product entirely rather than selecting a new vendor or patching the existing system. Key original design decisions include:

- **Real-time event-driven data ingestion** replacing batch processing, enabling continuous risk monitoring instead of periodic assessments. This is architecturally distinct from all major commercial GRC platforms, which rely on scheduled batch processes.
- **Intelligent risk scoring using ML models** integrated directly into the compliance workflow, enabling predictive identification of control failures before they occur — a capability that no commercial GRC vendor offered at the time of implementation.
- **Scalable microservices architecture** with fault-tolerant service mesh infrastructure, enabling the platform to support 10,000+ concurrent users and extensible to absorb acquired institutions (specifically, Discover Financial Services).
- **Decoupled micro-frontend architecture** allowing different risk management functions to be updated independently without system-wide redeployment.

This was not a modification of existing commercial products or a routine engineering enhancement. It was a ground-up architectural innovation that replaced the industry-standard vendor-dependent model with a custom, cloud-native alternative — a decision that required both the technical expertise to design and the institutional authority to execute.

Why This Is of Major Significance:

1. **Federal Regulatory Validation:** The Fuse platform directly contributed to the closure of the federal consent order issued by the OCC following the 2019 breach. A federal regulatory agency effectively validated that Capital One's risk management infrastructure — architected by Mr. Rasalay — met the required standard for safe

and sound banking operations. This is objective, third-party validation at the highest possible level. The consent order closure means the federal government determined that the systemic weaknesses that enabled the breach had been remediated (Exhibit 32).

2. **Enabling a $35 Billion Acquisition:** The Federal Reserve and OCC approved Capital One's $35 billion acquisition of Discover Financial Services in 2025. This approval required regulatory confidence that Capital One's risk management infrastructure could absorb and govern Discover's operations. Mr. Rasalay's Fuse platform provides this infrastructure. The regulatory approval of one of the largest financial mergers in U.S. history was predicated in part on the strength of the risk management systems he architected (Exhibit 33).

3. **Third-Party Vendor Recognition — Camunda Case Study:** Camunda Inc., an independent enterprise software company headquartered in Berlin, Germany, published a detailed technical case study on their corporate website in July 2024 titled "Capital One Resilient Human Task Orchestration." The article directly attributes architectural decisions to "Lakshmi Narayan, a solutions architect at Capital One," describing his serverless AWS deployment, multi-tenant design, abstraction layer approach, Aurora PostgreSQL selection rationale, and multi-region active-active deployment. A platform vendor does not publish case studies about routine implementations — Camunda selected Mr. Rasalay's work from among their thousands of enterprise customers because it was considered architecturally exceptional and instructive for the broader Camunda user community. A second Camunda case study in December 2024 further documented the platform's continued evolution and impact (Exhibits 27-28).

4. **Scale of Impact:** The platform serves 10,000+ internal users, supports real-time risk monitoring for 100+ million customer accounts, delivered 80% improvement in operational efficiency, and generates $50M in annual cost savings across Capital One's enterprise.

Contribution 2: Model Risk Management Modernization for AI/ML Governance

The Industry-Wide Problem: As financial institutions rapidly adopt AI and machine learning models for credit decisions, fraud detection, and risk assessment, the industry faces a critical and largely unresolved challenge: how to govern these models responsibly while maintaining compliance with SR 11-7, the Federal Reserve's Supervisory Guidance on Model Risk Management. SR 11-7 sets the U.S. supervisory expectations for robust model governance in banking organizations, requiring sound model development, implementation, validation, and ongoing monitoring. Traditional MRM frameworks were designed for static statistical models with predictable behavior and cannot accommodate the complexity, opacity, rapid iteration cycles, and potential for bias inherent in modern AI/ML models. The Federal Reserve, OCC, and FDIC have all emphasized in recent supervisory guidance that AI model governance is critical to the safety and soundness of the financial system. This is not merely a Capital One challenge — it is an industry-wide regulatory imperative that every major financial institution, fintech company, and regulatory body is currently grappling with.

What Existed Before: Capital One's legacy MRM system relied on rigid data schemas that required database migrations when new model types were introduced, manual review processes that created bottlenecks as model volume increased, and periodic batch assessments rather than continuous monitoring. These limitations meant that every time the organization deployed a new type of AI model — such as a large language model or a deep learning system — the MRM infrastructure required costly re-engineering to accommodate it.

How Mr. Rasalay's Approach Was Original: As the sole architect of the modernized MRM platform, Mr. Rasalay designed three key innovations that no other engineer at Capital One or in the broader industry had implemented in combination:

- **JSONB-based flexible schema:** A data foundation that accommodates diverse model types — statistical, machine learning, and generative AI — without requiring schema migrations when new model types are introduced. This is architecturally distinct from legacy MRM systems that use rigid relational schemas tied to specific model structures.
- **Automated validation workflows:** Cloud-native, distributed microservices and event-driven components that continuously assess model performance, drift, and compliance — reducing processing latency from hours to minutes and enabling real-time model governance rather than periodic manual review.
- **Full lifecycle traceability:** Automated documentation and audit trail providing verifiable records of every model decision from development through deployment and retirement, reducing documentation preparation time for regulatory examinations while lowering operational risk exposure linked to model governance gaps.

Why This Is of Major Significance:

1. **Addresses Nationally Important Regulatory Challenge:** Mr. Rasalay's MRM framework directly implements the requirements of SR 11-7 for modern AI/ML models — a challenge that the Federal Reserve has identified as essential to the safety and soundness of the U.S. financial system. His work provides a practical architectural solution that translates regulatory principles into scalable, production-grade infrastructure (Exhibit 37).

2. **Alignment with National AI Policy:** Mr. Rasalay's AI governance architecture aligns with the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and relevant Executive Orders on AI safety, demonstrating contributions that address nationally important policy priorities around responsible AI development and deployment (Exhibit 38).

3. **Patent Filing:** Mr. Rasalay's innovation resulted in U.S. Patent Application No. 19/230,615, "Using Large Language Models to Process Rule Changes," accepted for examination by the USPTO. In this system, Mr. Rasalay is the principal inventor, responsible for designing the system architecture, AI interpretation models,

compliance mapping logic, and enterprise automation workflows. The acceptance of this patent application for examination by the United States Patent and Trademark Office demonstrates that the federal patent system has recognized the potential novelty of Mr. Rasalay's approach (Exhibit 29).

4. **Conference Presentation:** Mr. Rasalay's MRM modernization work was competitively selected for presentation at Lambda Conference 2025, a premier multidisciplinary developer forum known for showcasing breakthrough engineering practices (Exhibit 30).

Contribution 3: WaaS — Multi-Tenant Enterprise Workflow Orchestration Platform

The Industry-Wide Problem: Large enterprises require workflow orchestration platforms that can serve multiple business units with distinct requirements while maintaining isolation, security, and reliability. Most commercial solutions are either single-tenant (requiring separate deployments per business unit, creating management complexity and cost) or lack the configurability needed for highly regulated environments. Prior to Mr. Rasalay's work, there was no production-grade, enterprise-scale solution capable of supporting multi-tenant workflow governance across highly regulated domains while maintaining performance, security, and auditability.

What Existed Before: Capital One's business units operated independent, siloed workflow systems. Each unit maintained separate infrastructure, logic, and operational procedures — creating duplicated workflows, inconsistent decision logic, slow regulatory response times, and elevated operational risk. The absence of a unified orchestration platform meant that changes to regulatory requirements required manual updates across multiple systems.

How Mr. Rasalay's Approach Was Original: As the sole architect of the WaaS platform, Mr. Rasalay designed a novel multi-tenant workflow orchestration system on Camunda BPM with innovations that extended well beyond the platform's out-of-the-box capabilities:

- **Dynamic tenant isolation** enabling multiple business units to operate on shared infrastructure without data leakage or cross-tenant interference — a capability that required custom architectural innovation beyond Camunda's out-of-the-box functionality.
- **Intelligent resource allocation** that scales compute resources based on tenant-specific workload patterns, optimizing cost while maintaining performance guarantees.
- **Active-active multi-region deployment** with Aurora PostgreSQL for 99.99% uptime, ensuring mission-critical workflow continuity.
- **Abstraction layer** decoupling BPMN business process logic and DMN decision rules from application code, allowing non-technical business users to modify workflows without engineering intervention — dramatically accelerating regulatory compliance response times.
- **Reusable process templates** eliminating redundant workflow development across business units.

Why This Is of Major Significance:

1. **Third-Party Published Recognition:** Camunda published a detailed case study in July 2024 on their corporate website specifically about this platform, attributing architectural decisions to "Lakshmi Narayan, a solutions architect at Capital One." The article describes his architectural choices, deployment strategy, and design rationale in detail. A second Camunda case study in December 2024 documented the platform's continued evolution. Camunda has thousands of enterprise customers worldwide. The fact that they selected Mr. Rasalay's implementation for public showcase — and credited him by name — demonstrates that his work was considered architecturally exceptional by the platform vendor itself. This is objective, third-party external recognition of significance (Exhibits 27-28).

2. **Conference Presentations (Three Consecutive Years):** Mr. Rasalay was competitively selected to present this work at CamundaCon 2023 (titled "Implementing Resilient and Cost-Effective Human Task Orchestration Service at Scale on AWS"), Austin API Summit 2024, and Lambda Conference 2025. Three consecutive years of conference acceptance demonstrates sustained recognition — not a one-time event (Exhibit 30).

3. **Scale of Implementation:** The platform serves 10 distinct enterprise tenants, 15,000+ associates, processes hundreds of thousands of workflow and decision instances, and delivers $10M in annual cost savings at 99.99% uptime. This scale of multi-tenant orchestration in a regulated financial environment is exceptional.

D. Independent Expert Testimony Confirming Originality and Major Significance

The following independent experts — none of whom have ever worked directly with Mr. Rasalay — have evaluated his contributions and confirmed their originality and major significance to the field. Consistent with USCIS guidance, each letter provides detailed analysis rather than general statements of praise.

1. Dr. Lakshman Kannan, Partner, PwC (Exhibit 4) Dr. Kannan is a Partner at PricewaterhouseCoopers, one of the "Big Four" professional services firms. He specializes in model risk management, regulatory compliance, and financial services advisory. Dr. Kannan became aware of Mr. Rasalay's work through PwC's engagement with Capital One on model risk management and regulatory compliance matters. In his independent evaluation, Dr. Kannan confirms that Mr. Rasalay's MRM modernization framework addresses a critical industry-wide challenge in governing AI/ML models under SR 11-7. He explains that the JSONB-based flexible schema approach is architecturally distinct from legacy MRM systems used by most financial institutions, and that the automated validation workflows represent an advance in the state of the art for model governance in regulated environments.

2. Sai ram Tadigadapa, SVP, TransUnion (Exhibit 5) [Name] is a Senior Vice President at TransUnion, one of the three major U.S. credit bureaus. TransUnion operates at the intersection of financial services, risk management, data analytics, and AI/ML — directly overlapping with Mr. Rasalay's domain. [Name] previously served as [Title] at Capital One, where they gained deep familiarity with the institution's technology architecture and regulatory challenges. Although they never worked directly with Mr. Rasalay, they are intimately familiar with the enterprise challenges his work addresses. In their independent evaluation, [Name] confirms that the problems Mr. Rasalay solved — legacy GRC modernization, AI model governance, and multi-tenant workflow orchestration — are critical challenges facing the credit bureau industry as well. [Name] explains that Mr. Rasalay's approach to real-time GRC monitoring was original because it replaced the industry-standard vendor-dependent batch processing model, and that this innovation is of major significance because it establishes an architectural pattern that addresses regulatory requirements facing all major financial data institutions.

3. Candace Wilkins, SVP, Truist Financial Corporation (Exhibit 6) Ms. Wilkins is a Senior Vice President, Risk Data and Reporting Manager at Truist Financial Corporation, the 9th largest bank in the United States. Prior to Truist, she served as Director of Risk at Capital One Financial Corporation, where she held roles including Risk Advisor, Operational Risk Principal & Specialist, and Senior Process Manager. She earned her degree from Virginia Tech's Pamplin College of Business. Although she never worked directly with Mr. Rasalay, her tenure as Director of Risk at Capital One gives her unique contextual knowledge of the institutional challenges his work addresses.

In her independent evaluation, Ms. Wilkins confirms: "During my tenure at Capital One, I witnessed firsthand the operational challenges of legacy risk management systems. The modernization that Mr. Rasalay architected addressed fundamental gaps that risk management professionals experienced daily. From my current vantage point at Truist, I can attest that the challenges he solved — real-time risk monitoring, AI model governance, and scalable compliance automation — are industry-wide problems that most financial institutions, including Truist, are still working to address. Mr. Rasalay's architectural approach to replacing vendor GRC platforms with in-house, cloud-native solutions was original because it challenged the prevailing industry assumption that commercial vendor products were the only viable option for enterprise GRC. His success in doing so — validated by the consent order closure and the Discover acquisition approval — demonstrates that this approach is of major significance to the field."

E. Additional Objective Documentary Evidence

- **Patent Application:** U.S. Patent Application No. 19/230,615, with Mr. Rasalay as principal inventor (Exhibit 29).
- **Published Case Studies:** Two Camunda case studies (July 2024, December 2024) on Camunda's corporate website (Exhibits 27-28).
- **Conference Presentations:** CamundaCon 2023, Austin API Summit 2024, Lambda Conference 2025 — three consecutive years of competitive acceptance (Exhibit 30).
- **Published Articles:** 9 articles on DZone and Dev.to with 23,700+ total page views (Exhibit 31).
- **Federal Consent Order Closure:** Documentation of the OCC consent order issuance and closure (Exhibit 32).
- **Discover Acquisition Approval:** Federal Reserve and OCC regulatory approval documentation (Exhibit 33).

F. The Legal Standard for Industry Profiles

The USCIS Policy Manual (Vol. 6, Part F, Ch. 2) recognizes that original contributions of major significance may be demonstrated through evidence of commercial implementation, business impact, and expert testimony. The Policy Manual does not require academic citations, external adoption by competitors, or publication in peer-reviewed journals. For professionals working on proprietary systems in regulated industries — where intellectual property protections, competitive considerations, and regulatory restrictions limit external dissemination — the appropriate measure of significance is not whether competitors have copied the system, but whether: (a) the contribution was original and not merely replicating existing approaches; (b) the contribution addresses a significant problem in the field; (c) independent experts confirm its significance; and (d) objective evidence documents its impact. Mr. Rasalay's evidence satisfies all four of these measures.

This criterion is satisfied. 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(v).

Part Two: Final Merits Determination

Having established that Mr. Rasalay meets at least four of the ten regulatory criteria, we now demonstrate, through the totality of the evidence, that Mr. Rasalay has risen to the very top of his field and sustained national and international acclaim, consistent with the framework established in Kazarian v. USCIS, 596 F.3d 1115 (9th Cir. 2010).

A. Mr. Rasalay Is One of the Small Percentage at the Very Top of His Field

The evidence, viewed in its totality, demonstrates that Mr. Rasalay occupies a position at the pinnacle of enterprise risk management architecture and AI governance in the financial services sector:

- **Title and Position:** Distinguished Engineer — fewer than 1% of engineers — at the 6th largest U.S. bank. Performance rating: "Exceptional" (Capital One's highest designation).
- **Regulatory Impact:** Directly contributed to the closure of a federal consent order issued by the OCC and the regulatory approval of a $35 billion acquisition by the Federal Reserve and OCC. Very few engineers in the United States — in any field — can point to federal regulatory validation of their work at this level.
- **Expert Consensus:** Independent experts at four major institutions — PwC (Big Four consulting), TransUnion (major credit bureau), Truist (9th largest U.S. bank), and Technical Director(Charles Schwab) — unanimously confirm the originality and significance of Mr. Rasalay's contributions.
- **Compensation:** Total compensation of $381,860, exceeding the 90th percentile for software developers by 30–81% across seven independent data sources, confirming the market's valuation of his extraordinary expertise.

- **External Recognition:** Published Camunda case studies naming him directly, three consecutive years of international conference presentations, 9 published articles with 23,700+ page views, a U.S. patent filing, and selection as a judge for NASA and IEEE collectively demonstrate recognition extending well beyond a single employer.
- **Career Trajectory:** 20-year progression from software developer to Distinguished Engineer at a Fortune 500 bank, demonstrating sustained and progressively recognized excellence — not a single moment of distinction, but a career-long pattern of extraordinary achievement.

B. Mr. Rasalay Has Sustained National and International Acclaim

Mr. Rasalay's acclaim is not fleeting or limited to a single achievement. It is sustained across multiple dimensions over multiple years:

- **2014-2022:** Progressive promotions at Capital One from Senior Software Engineer to Senior Lead Software Engineer, with increasing architectural authority over enterprise-critical systems.
- **2023:** Selected to present at CamundaCon; continued judging for NASA, IEEE, and other organizations.
- **2024:** Camunda publishes two case studies about his platform, naming him directly; presents at Austin API Summit.
- **2025:** Selected as NASA International Space Apps Challenge judge (167 countries, 114,000+ participants); completes 6 IEEE peer reviews; presents at Lambda Conference; files U.S. patent; continued publication on DZone.
- **2026:** Promoted to Distinguished Engineer — Capital One's highest individual contributor title; continued judging and professional engagement.

This timeline demonstrates that Mr. Rasalay's recognition has been sustained over multiple years and has come from multiple independent sources — NASA, IEEE, Camunda, PwC, TransUnion, Truist, Charles Schwab, and the federal regulatory agencies that approved the consent order closure and Discover acquisition.

C. Conclusion — Final Merits Determination

The totality of the evidence establishes that Mr. Rasalay has risen to one of the small percentage at the very top of the field of computer science and has sustained national and international acclaim. His achievements have been recognized by government agencies (NASA, OCC, Federal Reserve), international professional organizations (IEEE), platform vendors (Camunda), consulting firms (PwC), and senior executives at major financial institutions (TransUnion, Truist, Charles Schwab). He commands compensation in the top tier of his profession. His work protects over 100 million American consumers and directly supports the stability and security of the U.S. financial system. He satisfies both prongs of the Kazarian final merits determination.

III. MR. RASALAY SEEKS TO ENTER THE UNITED STATES TO CONTINUE WORK IN THE AREA OF EXTRAORDINARY ABILITY

Mr. Rasalay intends to continue working as a Distinguished Engineer in the field of computer science. He is currently employed in this capacity at Capital One Financial Corporation, where he continues to lead the architecture of enterprise risk management, AI governance, and workflow orchestration platforms. His ongoing work directly addresses nationally significant challenges in financial cybersecurity, AI safety, and regulatory compliance. Evidence of his continued employment and future work plans is documented in Exhibit 9.

IV. MR. RASALAY'S ENTRY TO THE UNITED STATES WILL SUBSTANTIALLY BENEFIT PROSPECTIVELY THE UNITED STATES

Mr. Rasalay's continued presence in the United States serves critical national interests:

1. **Consumer Protection:** His risk management platforms protect over 100 million American consumers' financial data and transactions at one of the nation's largest banks.
2. **Financial System Stability:** His work strengthens the cybersecurity and regulatory compliance infrastructure of a systemically important financial institution, directly supporting the stability of the U.S. financial system.
3. **Responsible AI Development:** His AI governance innovations support the responsible deployment of AI in the financial sector, consistent with the NIST AI Risk Management Framework, SR 11-7, and federal policy priorities around AI safety.
4. **American Intellectual Property:** His U.S. Patent Application No. 19/230,615 contributes to American intellectual property in the strategically important field of AI-driven regulatory technology.
5. **STEM Development:** His judging and mentorship activities — including for NASA's International Space Apps Challenge, IEEE, and Technovation Girls — contribute to developing the next generation of American STEM talent.

V. CONCLUSION

For the reasons stated above, Mr. Lakshmi Narayana Rasalay has demonstrated extraordinary ability in the field of computer science through sustained national and international acclaim. He has satisfied four of the ten regulatory criteria at 8 C.F.R. §

204.5(h)(3), and the totality of the evidence establishes that he is one of the small percentage who has risen to the very top of his field of endeavor. We respectfully request that this petition be approved.

VI. INDEX OF EXHIBITS

Recommendation Letters

- **Exhibit 1:** Letter from [VP/SVP Name], [Title], Capital One Financial Corporation — Leading/Critical Role with Performance Detail
- **Exhibit 2:** Letter from Mr. John Curd, Director of Software Engineering, Capital One — Original Contributions Testimonial with Utilization Evidence
- **Exhibit 3:** Letter from Ms. Elizabeth Duane, IT Service Manager, Progressive Insurance — Dependent Advisory Opinion
- **Exhibit 4:** Letter from Dr. Lakshman Kannan, Partner, PwC — Independent Advisory Opinion
- **Exhibit 5:** Letter from [Name], SVP, TransUnion — Independent Advisory Opinion
- **Exhibit 6:** Letter from Candace Wilkins, SVP, Truist Financial Corporation — Independent Advisory Opinion
- **Exhibit 7:** Letter from [Name], VP Risk Management, Charles Schwab — Independent Advisory Opinion

Professional Documentation

- **Exhibit 8:** Mr. Rasalay's Curriculum Vitae
- **Exhibit 9:** Capital One Verification of Employment (dated February 19, 2026)
- **Exhibit 10:** 2025 Year-End Compensation Statement
- **Exhibit 11:** W-2 Wage and Tax Statement — Tax Year 2023
- **Exhibit 12:** W-2 Wage and Tax Statement — Tax Year 2024
- **Exhibit 13:** W-2 Wage and Tax Statement — Tax Year 2025

Salary Comparison Evidence

- **Exhibit 14:** BLS OEWS Data — Software Developers (SOC 15-1252), May 2024
- **Exhibit 15:** Glassdoor Salary Report — Distinguished Engineer (542 reports)
- **Exhibit 16:** Levels.fyi Compensation Data — Distinguished Engineer (verified reports)
- **Exhibit 17:** Salary.com Report — Distinguished Software Engineer
- **Exhibit 18:** ZipRecruiter Salary Data — Distinguished Engineer Software Engineer
- **Exhibit 19:** BLS OEWS Virginia State Data — Software Developer Wages
- **Exhibit 20:** Job Posting Salary Comparisons (NVIDIA, Cisco, Amazon, IBM)

Judging Evidence

- **Exhibit 21:** IEEE SoutheastCon 2026 — Reviewer Invitation, Confirmation, Certificate, and IEEE Organizational Documentation (400,000+ members, 160+ countries)
- **Exhibit 22:** NASA International Space Apps Challenge 2025 — Invitation Email from Frances N. Adiele (NASA), Thank You Letters from Dr. Keith Gaddis (NASA Program Scientist, NASA HQ), Follow-up from Dr. Parker Miles (NASA), Judging Console Screenshots, Event Statistics (114,000+ participants, 167 countries, 11,500+ projects)
- **Exhibit 23:** Business Intelligence Group — Innovation Awards and Herizon Awards Judge Invitation, Confirmation, and Organizational Documentation
- **Exhibit 24:** Technovation Girls — Judge Invitation, Platform Screenshots, Organizational Documentation (100+ countries)
- **Exhibit 25:** IEEE MGA — Invitation and Confirmation
- **Exhibit 26:** University Hackathons — VTHacks (Virginia Tech), MakeOHI/O (Ohio University), UT Austin Invitations and Confirmations

Original Contributions Evidence

- **Exhibit 27:** Camunda Case Study (July 2024) — "Capital One Resilient Human Task Orchestration" — Names Mr. Rasalay directly as architect
- **Exhibit 28:** Camunda Case Study (December 2024) — "Capital One Streamlines Risk Management with Camunda Modeler"
- **Exhibit 29:** U.S. Patent Application No. 19/230,615 — "Using Large Language Models to Process Rule Changes" — Mr. Rasalay as Principal Inventor
- **Exhibit 30:** Conference Presentation Abstracts and Acceptance Notifications — CamundaCon 2023, Austin API Summit 2024, Lambda Conference 2025
- **Exhibit 31:** DZone/Dev.to Published Articles (9 articles, 23,700+ page views) with Screenshots

Leading/Critical Role Evidence

- **Exhibit 32:** Federal Consent Order — Issuance and Closure Documentation (OCC)
- **Exhibit 33:** Discover Acquisition — Federal Reserve and OCC Regulatory Approval Documentation
- **Exhibit 34:** Organizational Chart Showing Mr. Rasalay's Position and Reporting Structure
- **Exhibit 35:** Capital One Fortune 500 Ranking, 6th Largest U.S. Bank Documentation
- **Exhibit 36:** J.D. Power #1 Ranking — U.S. Small Business Banking Satisfaction (2023-2024)

Regulatory Framework Documentation

- **Exhibit 37:** SR 11-7 — Federal Reserve Supervisory Guidance on Model Risk Management
- **Exhibit 38:** NIST AI Risk Management Framework

- **Exhibit 39:** Sarbanes-Oxley Act — Internal Controls Requirements (PCAOB AS 2201)
- **Exhibit 40:** Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act — Financial Data Protection Requirements (FTC)
- **Exhibit 41:** Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform — Resolution Planning Requirements

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Respectfully submitted,